PRACTICAL REPORT

Creating Directories and Files in Kali Linux

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Date: _____

1. Introduction

This practical introduces basic file and directory management in Kali Linux through the terminal. The tasks practise checking locations, listing contents, creating directories and files, writing and reading text, renaming files, copying files, and displaying a directory tree.

2. Objectives

• Navigate the Linux file system using terminal commands.

• Create and inspect directories and text files.

• Write text to a file and display its contents.

• Rename and copy files using command-line utilities.

• Display a directory hierarchy using tree.

3. Tools Used

Kali Linux terminal and the commands pwd, ls, cd, mkdir, touch, echo, cat, mv, cp, and tree.

4. Procedure, Results, and Discussion

Task 1: Print current location and list its contents

Question: Print your current location, then list what is in it.

Commands / evidence: Commands: pwd, ls.

pwd prints the current working directory. ls lists items in that directory. The screenshot shows /home/keysha and its visible folders and files.

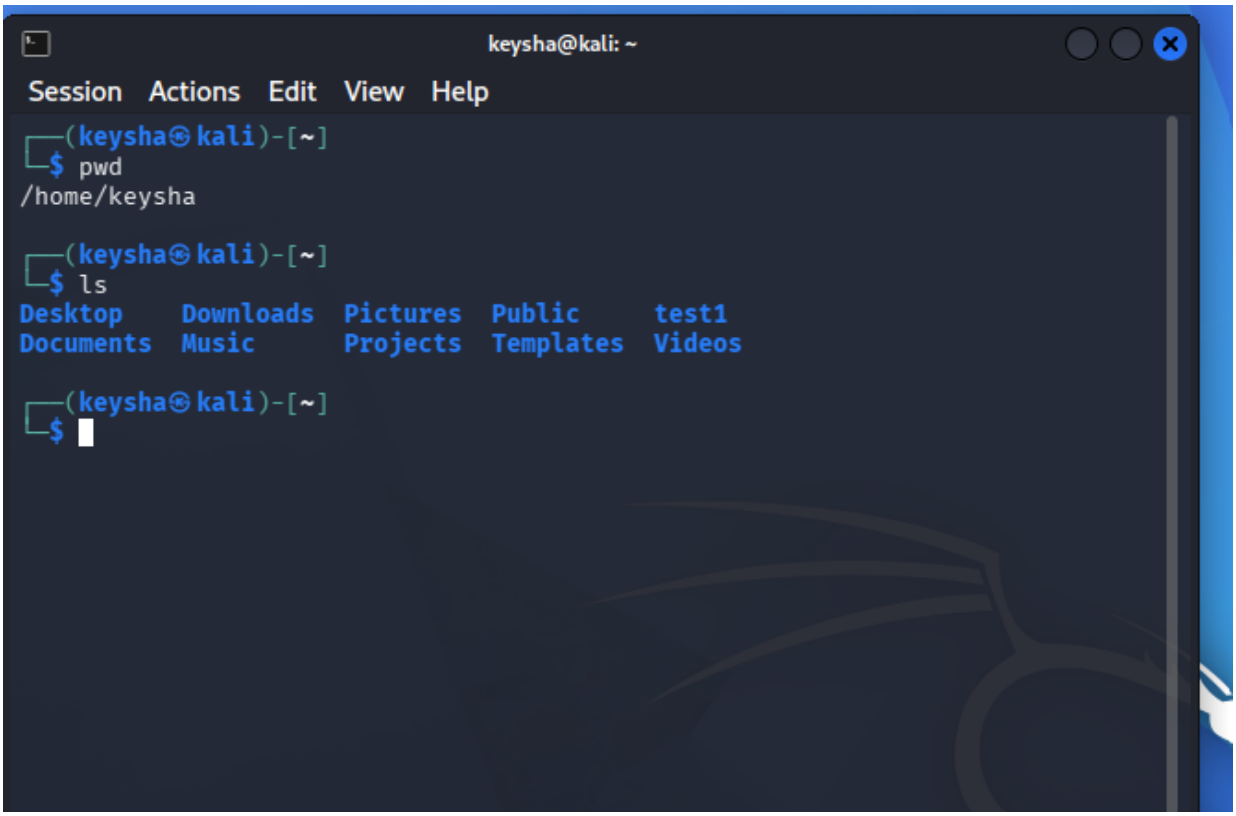


Figure 1: Screenshot evidence for Task 1: Print current location and list its contents.

Task 2: Create Assignment1 and enter it

Question: Create a directory named Assignment1 in your home folder and move into it.

Commands / evidence: Commands: cd, mkdir Assignment1, cd Assignment1, pwd.

cd without an argument returns to the home directory. mkdir creates the directory, cd enters it, and pwd confirms /home/keysha/Assignment1.

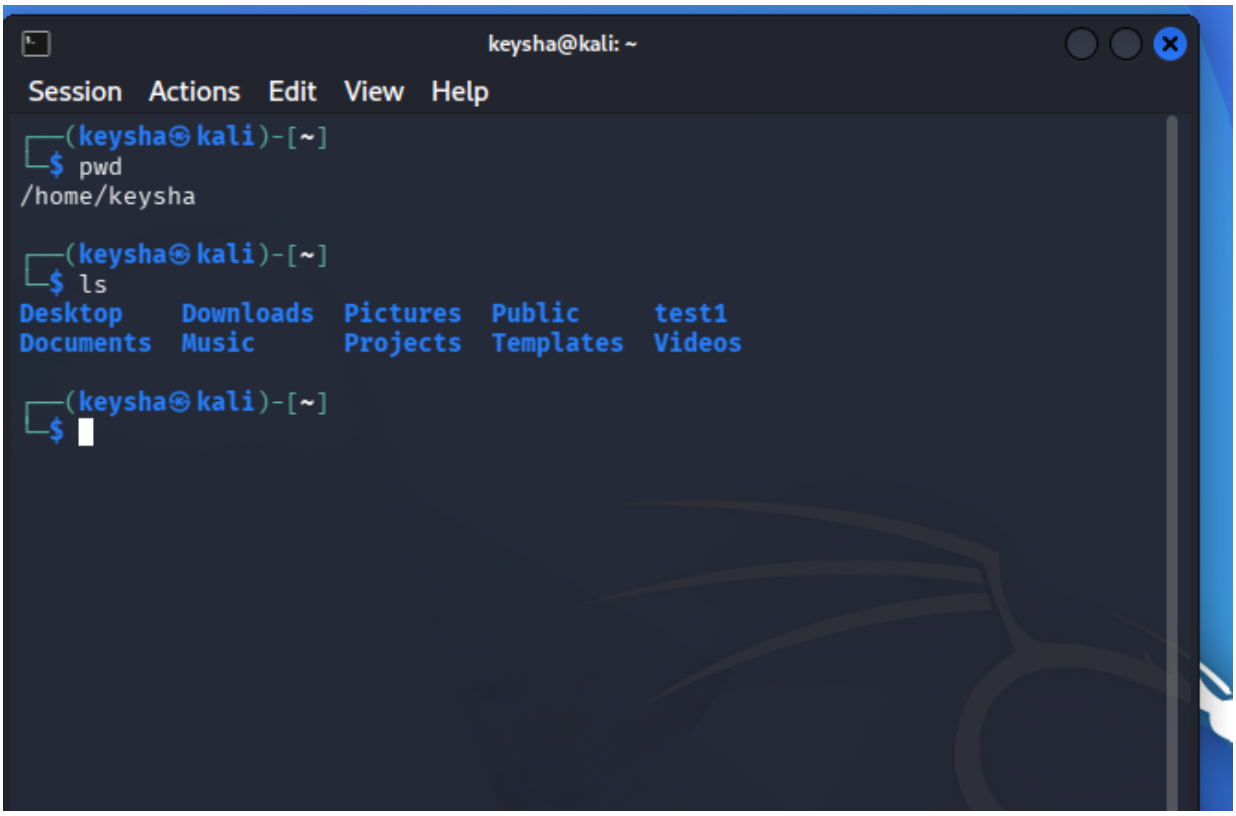


Figure 2: Screenshot evidence for Task 2: Create Assignment1 and enter it.

Task 3: Create Documents, Scripts, and Notes

Question: Inside Assignment1, create three directories named Documents, Scripts, and Notes.

Commands / evidence: Commands shown: mkdir Documents Scriptss Notes, ls.

mkdir creates directories and ls lists them. The screenshot shows Documents, Notes, and Scriptss. The assignment requires Scripts, so correct the extra s before final submission.

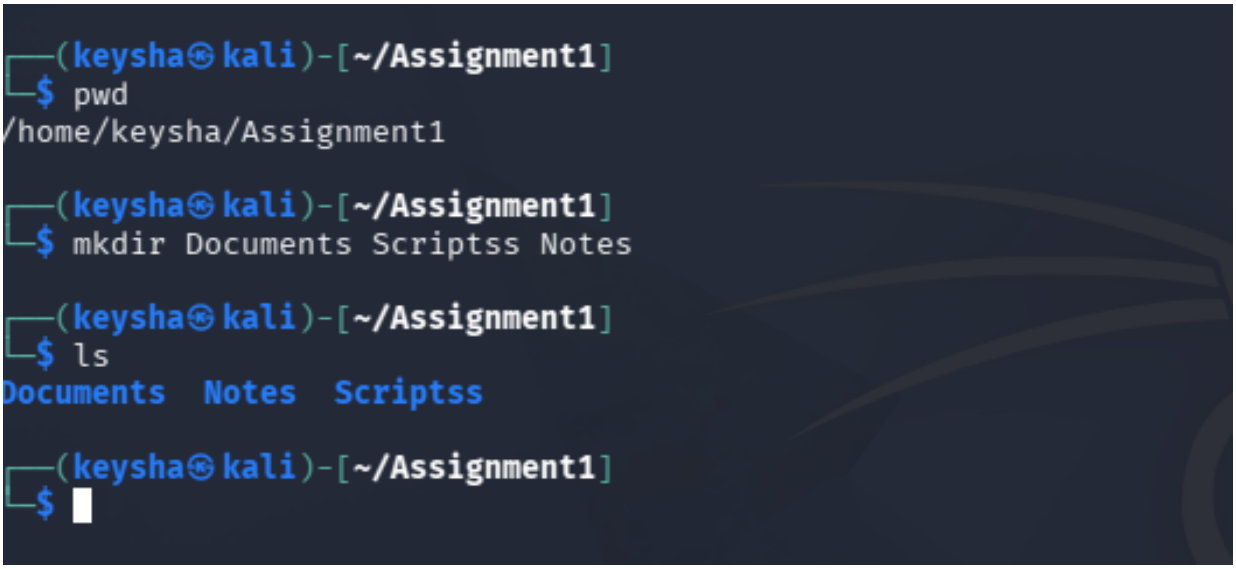


Figure 3: Screenshot evidence for Task 3: Create Documents, Scripts, and Notes.

Task 4: Create report.txt and summary.txt

Question: Move into Documents, create two empty files named report.txt and summary.txt, and list the folder.

Commands / evidence: Commands: cd Documents, touch report.txt summary.txt, ls.

touch creates empty files. The ls output confirms report.txt and summary.txt exist.

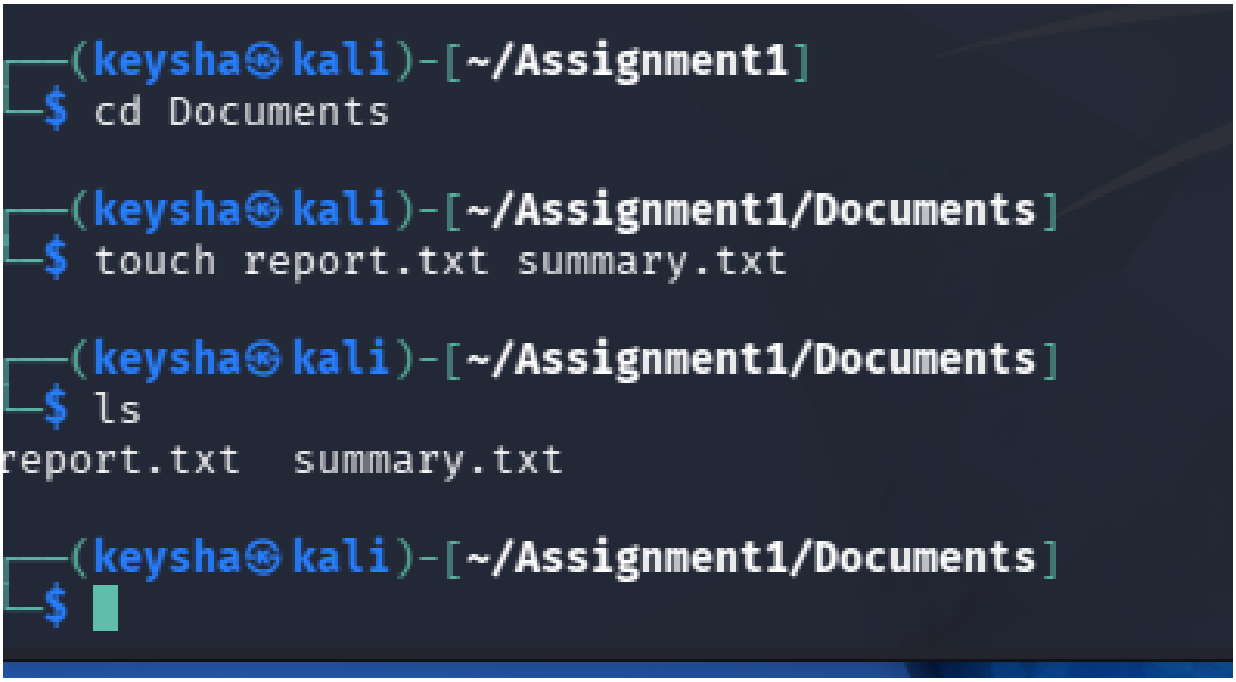


Figure 4: Screenshot evidence for Task 4: Create report.txt and summary.txt.

Task 5: Create about.txt with a sentence

Question: Move into Notes and create about.txt containing one sentence about yourself.

Commands / evidence: Command shown: echo with the sentence redirected to about.txt using >.

echo outputs text and > redirects it into a file. This creates about.txt if needed and replaces existing contents. The screenshot shows the sentence was written to the file.

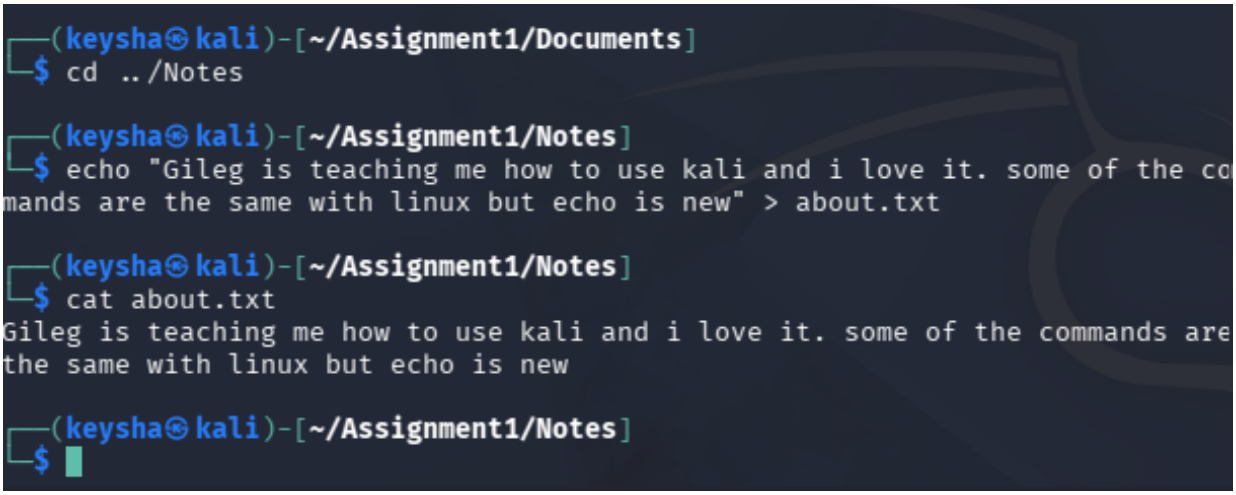


Figure 5: Screenshot evidence for Task 5: Create about.txt with a sentence.

Task 6: Display about.txt

Question: Display the contents of about.txt on the screen.

Commands / evidence: Command: cat about.txt.

cat displays a file's contents in the terminal. The screenshot shows the saved sentence.

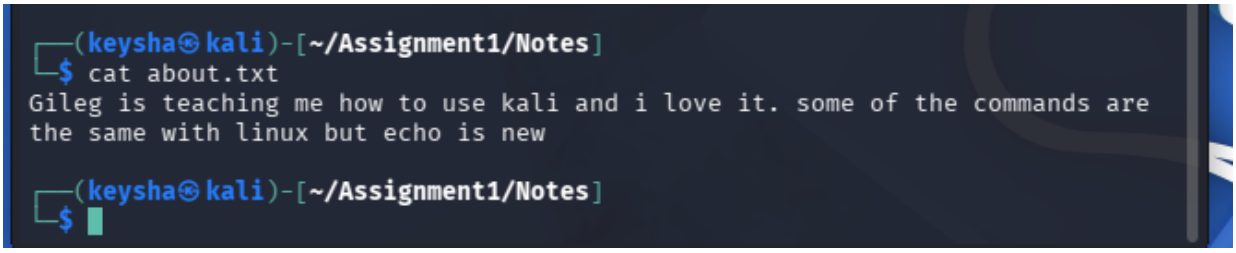


Figure 6: Screenshot evidence for Task 6: Display about.txt.

Task 7: Create and display hello.sh

Question: Move into Scripts, create hello.sh containing echo "Hello from Kali", and display the file.

Commands / evidence: Commands shown: cd ../Scriptss, echo 'echo "Hello from Kali"' > hello.sh, cat hello.sh.

The outer single quotes preserve the inner double quotes as text in the file. cat confirms the saved line. The screenshot uses Scriptss, which should be corrected to Scripts.

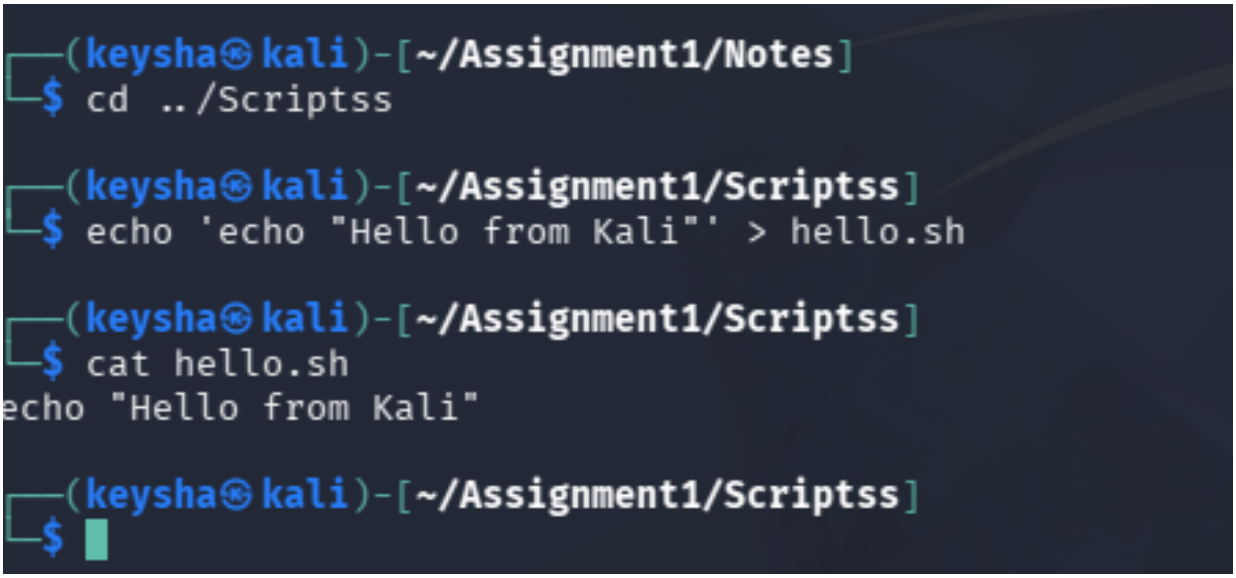


Figure 7: Screenshot evidence for Task 7: Create and display hello.sh.

Task 8: Rename summary.txt

Question: Go back to Documents and rename summary.txt to final_summary.txt. List the folder to confirm.

Commands / evidence: Commands: cd ../Documents, mv summary.txt final_summary.txt, ls.

mv renames a file when source and destination are in the same directory. The output shows final_summary.txt and report.txt.

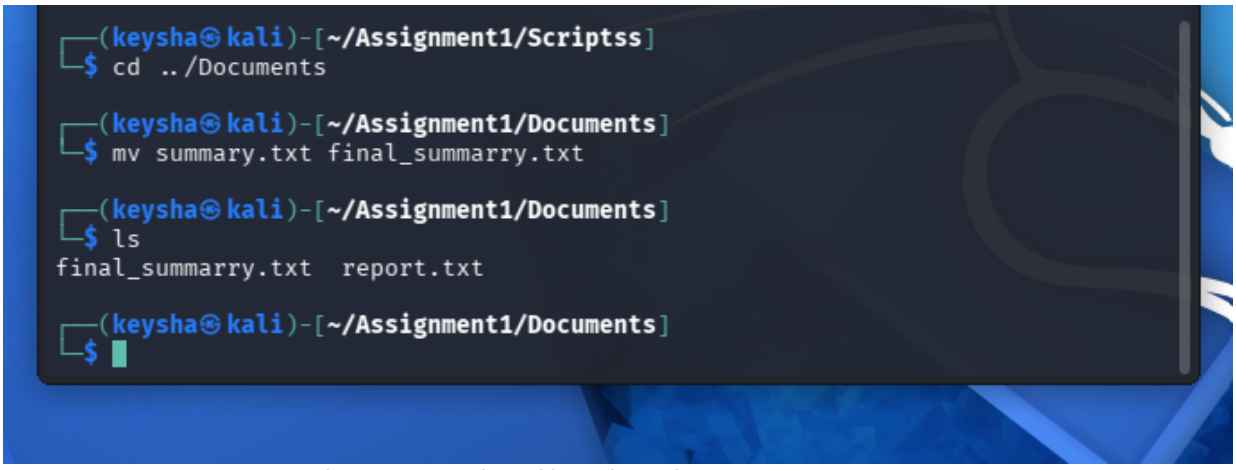


Figure 8: Screenshot evidence for Task 8: Rename summary.txt.

Task 9: Create Backup and copy about.txt

Question: Return to your home folder, create Backup, copy about.txt from Notes into Backup, and list Backup.

Commands / evidence: Commands attempted: mkdir Backup; attempted cp commands.

The screenshots show the copy failed: first, cannot stat / No such file or directory, then Permission denied. Backup was created in /home/keysha, but a successful copy is not proven. After checking paths, try cp ~/Assignment1/Notes/about.txt ~/Backup/ and confirm with ls ~/Backup. If it still fails, inspect permissions with ls -ld ~/Assignment1 ~/Assignment1/Notes ~/Backup.

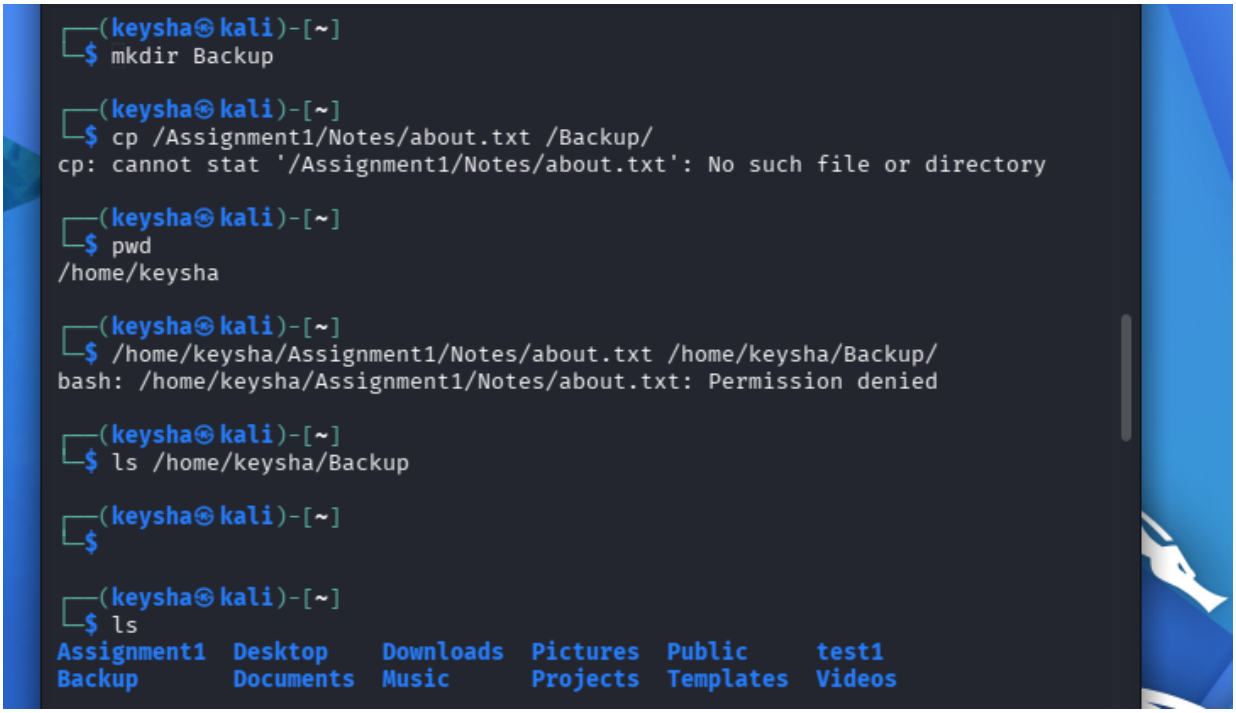


Figure 9: Screenshot evidence for Task 9: Create Backup and copy about.txt.

Task 10: Show the full directory tree

Question: Show the full structure in one tree. If tree is missing, install it first.

Commands / evidence: Command shown: tree Assignment1.

The tree output shows Documents with final_summary.txt and report.txt, Notes with about.txt, and Scriptss with hello.sh. It reports four directories and four files. Correct Scriptss to Scripts; after fixing Task 9, capture tree Assignment1 Backup if needed.

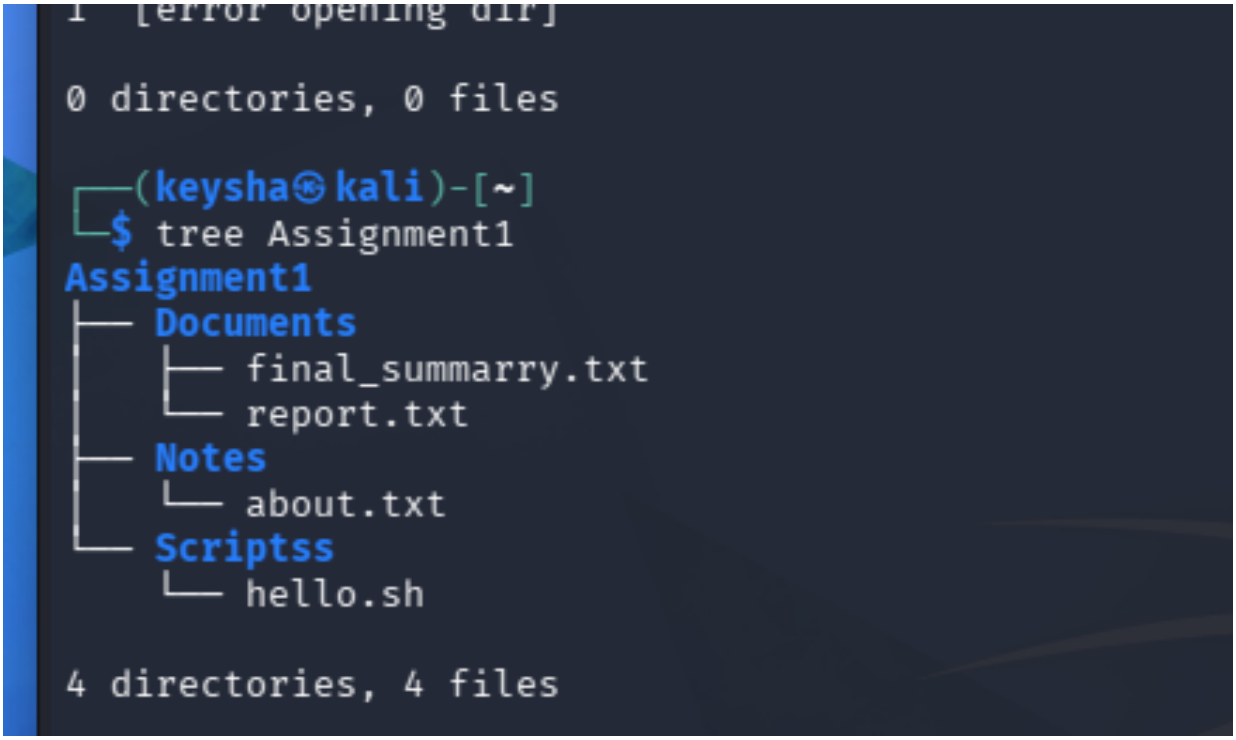


Figure 10: Screenshot evidence for Task 10: Show the full directory tree.

5. Challenges Encountered and Recommendations

Task 9 remains incomplete in the evidence because the copy command returned errors. Check the current location with pwd, verify the source with ls ~/Assignment1/Notes, and inspect the destination with ls ~/Backup. Then run cp ~/Assignment1/Notes/about.txt ~/Backup/ and confirm with ls ~/Backup. If permission is still denied, inspect directory permissions rather than using sudo blindly.

The directory is named Scriptss in the screenshots, but the task requires Scripts. Correct the spelling and ensure hello.sh is inside the correctly named directory before capturing final evidence.

6. Conclusion

This practical provided experience with core Kali Linux commands for navigation, directory and file creation, writing and displaying text, renaming, and viewing directory structure. Most tasks have screenshot evidence. Task 9 needs a successful copy confirmation, and the Scriptss spelling should be corrected so the final work matches the assignment instructions.

This report records the results shown in the supplied screenshots and does not claim that Task 9 succeeded.